

First off, you need to have a genuine copy of Windows to be able to install Windows Live Mail; when you go to the download link, <http://get.live.com/wlmail/overview>, and click on the “Get it free” link, you’ll be downloading a small file that will probably ask you to get your computer up to date at Microsoft Update—and the first step to that is, of course, the Windows Genuine Advantage Validation. After that’s done, the downloader gets to work and installs the software which, right on first run without any prompting, brings up the following:



Live Mail will import your OE mails when you install it—without prompting you

So there you have it—all your OE mails imported. The first thing you’ll notice is the way your mails are categorised: they’re under your individual accounts (POP3 or IMAP), each

of which has the “default” set of folders such as Deleted Items, Inbox, etc. This is followed by an automatically-inserted Hotmail, which in turn is followed by any other folders you might have created (such as “Work” or “Personal”). You’ll get it when you take a look.

Then, you can right-click on a message and select “Junk E-mail”; then, you can perform one of several actions, including marking the mail as junk, or adding the sender’s domain to the Blocked list. Yes, Windows Live Mail has a junk mail filter much like that in Outlook (MS Office)—you can choose from two levels of strictness, or choose to go by lists of blocked and allowed senders. Early reports indicated that the junk mail filter didn’t work well at all, and though we didn’t test the filter, there are so many bad reviews out there that we’re pretty sure it’s bad.

Then, like we said, for some strange reason, while OE would search your mails for a



Note the toolbar at the top, and the different way of categorisation